

Your Play — Reading the Room at 6 Weeks In

You have the technical logic locked. This is about the human side of an old-school garage.

THE ONE RISK THAT SINKS EVERYTHING

You wheeled your box in six weeks ago. Drop a full financial overhaul on a 40-year owner's desk yourself, and Jack's first thought isn't "smart" — it's **"who's this new guy trying to run my shop?"** The ideas can be perfect and still die on that reaction alone. The work isn't the risk. The *delivery* is.

THE MOVE: LET THE SON CARRY IT

Do **not** hand this to Jack solo. Give it to **his son first**. Frame it humbly — *"a few things I noticed in my first 30 days, wanted your take before I bother your dad."* Let the son own it and present it to Jack. You load the gun; he pulls the trigger. A son pitching his father reads as the future of the business. The new tech pitching the founder reads as a threat. Same playbook, opposite outcome.

WHY THIS WORKS

It's *his* shop and *his* family. The playbook is even named "The Heilman Playbook" for this reason — it's their plan, you just did the homework. Stay the expert who spotted the opportunities, never the outsider rewriting the business.

HOW TO PLAY IT

1. **Lead with the no-risk wins.** The already-built website, the 90-day grandfather, the one-shop pilot. Easy yeses first — they build trust for the big bet (the rate).
 2. **Let your wrench earn the standing.** Your 15 years of European diagnostic work is your credibility. Fix the cars nobody else can first; the financial ideas land far better once you're the guy who solved the hard ones.
 3. **Pitch it as observations, not directives.** "Here's what I noticed" — never "here's how you should run this." Curiosity and respect open the door that any lecture slams.
 4. **Be patient.** Six weeks in, you're planting, not closing. If it takes a few conversations over a few weeks, that's a win, not a stall.
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For Reed only. The owner-facing version is The Heilman Playbook — the case, not the choreography.